

Navigate to:

HLM\SOFTWARE\Microsoft\Windows\CurrentVersion\Uninstall

Look for the program name there, and delete the key.

If you can't find the program, look in one of the sub-keys whose names start with a curly brace. Then look for the program name in the DisplayName sub-key within that key. Delete the entire key (the one whose name begins with a curly brace).

Use this hack with care—you don't want to mess with Windows by deleting a wrong key.

Silence Those Beeps

System beeps can be useful. And they can be quite irritating.

Navigate to:

HCU\Control Panel\Sound

You'll find the String Value called Beep on the right. Modify it to "no" to disable beeps, or to "yes" to enable them. A restart is required for the change to take effect.

Do Away With The List

OK. How often have you come across a file with a non-standard extension, wanted to view its contents, and then selected Notepad from the list of available programs? Here's how to associate all unknown-extension files with Notepad, so they open with that program by default.

Navigate to:

HCR\Unknown\shell

Create a new key called "notepad" (without the quotes). Right-click this key and create a sub-key called "command". Now set the "(Default)" String Values of the following as below, without quotes: